



AGAPAY

Stripe Account & Payouts Guide

A clear walkthrough for parish and monastery administrators to verify Stripe, manage payouts, and understand deposits.

Verify

Complete Stripe identity and organization checks.

Deposit

Connect the parish bank account used for payouts.

Reconcile

Read balances, transactions, fees, and payout history.

Prepared for Orthodox parishes and monasteries using AGAPAY

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SECTION —

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NOTE

This guide is written for the current AGAPAY Stripe Connect / Express setup. Stripe, IRS, and banking rules can change, so AGAPAY may update this guide periodically.

SECTION 1

Understanding How AGAPAY Uses Stripe

AGAPAY uses Stripe Connect with Stripe Express accounts so each parish or monastery can receive online gifts through its own connected Stripe account. Stripe handles card processing, onboarding, identity verification, and payout mechanics; AGAPAY provides the Orthodox giving platform and support layer.



AGAPAY does not require your parish to create a separate standard Stripe account at stripe.com. Your Stripe Express account is connected through AGAPAY and is accessed from the AGAPAY admin portal or a secure Stripe Express login link.

NOTE

A Stripe Express account is different from a full Stripe dashboard account. For most parish tasks, start inside AGAPAY and use the “Manage Stripe Account” or “Stripe Dashboard” link.

Key Concepts

Term	Plain-English Meaning
Stripe Express Account	Your parish’s connected Stripe account, accessed through AGAPAY or Stripe Express.
Stripe Connect	Stripe’s platform system that links AGAPAY to parish-level connected accounts.
Payout	A transfer from your Stripe balance to the parish bank account.
Pending Balance	Funds collected but not yet available for payout.
Available Balance	Funds that have cleared and are ready to be paid out according to the payout schedule.
Verification / KYC	Identity and business checks required before Stripe releases funds.
AGAPAY Application Fee	AGAPAY’s per-transaction platform fee, deducted before the net amount is deposited.

SECTION 2

Accessing Your Stripe Express Dashboard

Your Stripe Express dashboard is where you review account status, bank details, payout history, transaction activity, and verification alerts.

How to Access Your Dashboard

- 1** Log in to your AGAPAY Admin Portal
Visit agapay.app and sign in with your parish administrator credentials. Contact AGAPAY support if you have not yet received credentials.
- 2** Open Payments or Settings
In your AGAPAY dashboard, look for the Payments or Settings section.
- 3** Choose "Manage Stripe Account"
Click the button or link labeled Manage Stripe Account, Stripe Dashboard, or similar. Stripe may open in a new tab.
- 4** Use the secure link when prompted
Stripe may ask you to confirm by email or text. Do not share dashboard links or login credentials with anyone who is not authorized for parish finances.

IMPORTANT

Treat AGAPAY admin access as financial access. Use a dedicated parish administrator account, strong password, and two-factor authentication wherever available.

What You May See in Stripe Express

Dashboard Area	What It Shows
Home / Overview	Current balance, recent payouts, and any actions needed.
Balances or Earnings	Pending funds, available funds, and recent activity.
Payouts	Deposits sent to the parish bank account, with dates and amounts.
Transactions	Individual gifts and payments processed through the parish giving page.
Account Settings	Organization details, representative information, bank account details, and verification status.

SECTION 3

Completing Identity Verification

Before Stripe can release funds to a bank account, Stripe must verify the parish or monastery and the authorized person acting as the account representative. This is a standard requirement for financial platforms and applies even when the organization is a church or monastery.

IMPORTANT

Do not wait to complete verification. If Stripe still needs information, donations may process, but payouts can be delayed or paused until the required information is accepted.

Information to Have Ready

Parish / Organization	Authorized Representative
Legal name of the parish or monastery	Full legal name
EIN / Tax ID	Date of birth
Physical mailing address	Home address
Phone number and email	Email and phone number
Parish website or AGAPAY page	Last four digits of SSN, or more if Stripe requires it
Organization type, usually religious nonprofit	Government ID or other document if requested

Step-by-Step Verification

- 1** Open Stripe Express
Use the AGAPAY admin portal to open the connected Stripe Express dashboard.
- 2** Look for alerts
Stripe will usually show a banner such as Complete your account setup or Verify information if action is required.
- 3** Enter organization information
Use the parish's legal name and EIN exactly as they appear in parish records and IRS records.
- 4** Enter representative information
Use an authorized person such as the treasurer, council president, or priest, depending on parish governance.

SECTION 3 continued

Completing Identity Verification

- 1** Upload documents if requested
If Stripe asks for a document, upload a clear image or PDF. Blurry, cropped, or expired documents often cause delays.
- 2** Submit and monitor status
Stripe review can be quick, but additional review may take longer. Return to the dashboard if Stripe asks for updated information.
- 3** Tell AGAPAY if you get stuck
AGAPAY can often help identify what Stripe is requesting and guide you through the next step.

NOTE

The account representative does not have to be the priest unless your parish chooses that arrangement. Select an authorized parish officer who can respond promptly to verification requests.

Accuracy Checklist

- The legal name matches parish records and IRS records.
- The EIN is entered correctly.
- The representative's name, address, date of birth, and SSN information are accurate.
- The parish bank account is not a personal account.
- All Stripe alerts are resolved before relying on automatic payouts.

SECTION 4

Adding & Managing Your Bank Account

After the parish account is connected, Stripe needs the parish bank account where payouts should be deposited. AGAPAY currently supports U.S. bank accounts for U.S. parishes and monasteries.

Adding Your Bank Account

- 1** Open Stripe Express
Access the dashboard through the AGAPAY admin portal.
- 2** Go to Account Settings
Look for Account, Settings, Bank Accounts, External Accounts, or Payout Details.
- 3** Add the bank account
Enter the parish routing number and account number carefully. Use a parish account, not a personal account.
- 4** Choose the account type
Most parishes should use a dedicated checking account. Use savings only if that is truly the parish payout account.
- 5** Complete verification if required
Stripe may verify instantly or may require microdeposits. Follow the instructions in Stripe Express.

TIP

Before entering bank information, confirm the routing number and account number with your treasurer, bank portal, or official bank records. Do not rely on a handwritten note unless it has been verified.

Where to Find Bank Details

Where to Look	Routing Number	Account Number
Paper check	Bottom-left, usually 9 digits	Usually middle-bottom; length varies
Online banking portal	Account details or routing information	Account details or account information
Bank mobile app	Account details, routing info, or "view details"	Account details, account info, or "view details"
Call the bank	Ask for the ACH routing number	Ask for the checking / DDA account number

SECTION 4 continued

Adding & Managing Your Bank Account

Changing Your Bank Account

If your parish changes banks or opens a new operating account, update Stripe before closing the old account. Add the new account in Stripe Express, confirm it works, and then remove the old payout destination only after successful payout activity.

IMPORTANT

If a parish closes its bank account before updating Stripe, payouts may fail and funds may be held while the issue is corrected. Contact AGAPAY support immediately if this happens.

Practical Controls for Parish Stewardship

- Limit dashboard and bank-editing access to authorized financial officers.
- Keep written parish records showing who is authorized to update payout information.
- Review payout deposits against AGAPAY and Stripe records at least monthly.
- Immediately investigate any payout that does not match your records.

SECTION 5

Understanding Your Payout Schedule

Stripe does not send each donation to the bank immediately. Donations first move through Stripe's balance system. Once funds become available, Stripe sends payouts according to the parish's payout schedule and Stripe's risk and compliance requirements.

Common Schedule Options

Schedule Type	How It Works	Best Use
Daily	Available funds are paid out on business days according to Stripe timing.	Recommended for most parishes.
Weekly	Available funds accumulate and are deposited once per week.	Useful when the treasurer reconciles weekly.
Monthly	Available funds accumulate and are deposited once per month.	Useful for larger parishes with monthly bookkeeping cycles.
Manual	Funds remain in Stripe until a manual payout is triggered.	Use only when there is a specific accounting reason.

Timing Expectations

Payout timing can vary by payment method, account history, Stripe review, banking holidays, and bank processing. New accounts may experience longer initial payout timing. Once available, bank arrival commonly takes one or more business days, depending on the bank.

Changing the Schedule

- 1 Open Stripe Express
Access through the AGAPAY admin portal.
- 2 Find payout settings
Look for Bank Accounts, Payout Details, or Payout Schedule.
- 3 Select the preferred frequency
Daily is usually best for parish cash flow and reconciliation.
- 4 Save and monitor the next payout
Review the next deposit to confirm the schedule is working as expected.

TIP

For most parish treasurers, daily payouts provide the clearest view of recent giving and make failed deposits easier to spot quickly.

SECTION 6

Reading Your Balance & Transaction History

Stripe Express gives your parish a working view of donation activity, balances, fees, and bank payouts. The exact labels may vary as Stripe updates its dashboard, but the concepts below remain useful for reconciliation.

Understanding Balances

Balance Type	What It Means	What Happens Next
Pending	Donations received but not yet available for payout.	Moves to available after Stripe clearance and any review period.
Available	Funds cleared and ready to be paid out.	Included in a payout according to the schedule.
In Transit	Funds already sent from Stripe but not yet posted by the bank.	Arrives when the bank completes processing.

Viewing Transactions

Open Transactions or Activity to see individual donations. For each donation, the dashboard may show the date, gross amount, Stripe processing fee, AGAPAY application fee, payment method, net amount, and transaction ID.

NOTE

Export transaction history as a CSV when available. This is helpful for bookkeeping, annual donor reports, and audit trails.

Viewing Payout History

Open Payouts to see deposits sent to the parish bank account. Each payout should show the amount, initiation date, expected arrival date, and the transactions included in the payout. Reconcile payouts against bank deposits and parish giving records.

SECTION 7

Handling Common Issues

Payouts Are Not Arriving

- Confirm the bank account is entered correctly and verified.
- Check whether funds are still pending or under review.
- Look for Stripe dashboard alerts requiring information.
- Confirm identity verification is complete.
- Contact AGAPAY if the delay continues beyond the expected payout window.

Stripe Requests More Information

- Open Stripe Express and read the alert carefully.
- Provide the specific document or correction requested.
- Make sure the parish legal name and EIN match IRS records.
- Respond promptly; unresolved requests can pause payouts.
- Ask AGAPAY for help if the request is unclear.

Refunds or Disputes

- Refunds and disputes may reduce your available balance.
- If the balance becomes negative, Stripe may offset a future payout.
- Contact AGAPAY immediately if you receive a dispute notice.
- Keep donor communications and giving records for parish bookkeeping.

Bank Account Rejected

- Re-check routing and account numbers.
- Confirm the account is open, active, and in the parish's name.
- Ask the bank whether ACH deposits are enabled.
- Re-enter the bank account or contact AGAPAY support.

SECTION 8

Fees & What Gets Deposited

The example below assumes a standard domestic card donation under AGAPAY's current pricing. Stripe pricing can vary by payment method, card type, country, manual entry, international cards, currency conversion, or other circumstances.

Fee Breakdown Per Donation

Fee Component	Amount	Who Collects It
Stripe processing fee	2.9% + \$0.30 for standard domestic online card transactions	Stripe
AGAPAY application fee	5% + \$0.30 per donation	AGAPAY platform fee
Net to parish	Remainder after applicable fees	Deposited to parish bank account

Example Calculation

	\$25 Donation	\$100 Donation	\$250 Donation
Donor gives	\$25.00	\$100.00	\$250.00
Stripe fee (2.9% + \$0.30)	-\$1.03	-\$3.20	-\$7.55
AGAPAY fee (5% + \$0.30)	-\$1.55	-\$5.30	-\$12.80
Net to parish	\$22.42	\$91.50	\$229.65

NOTE

Monthly platform subscriptions are separate from per-donation fees. If AGAPAY offers a monastery discount, parish plan, or special pricing arrangement, that separate agreement controls.

Tax Reporting

Stripe may provide Form 1099-K reporting when applicable under federal or state rules. Current federal reporting has reverted to the higher threshold of more than \$20,000 and more than 200 transactions, but state rules and future law can differ. A 1099-K reports gross processed payments; it does not decide whether funds are taxable. Parishes should consult their accountant or tax advisor.

SECTION 9

Contacting Support

AGAPAY is the first stop for most questions about the AGAPAY giving platform, Stripe Express access, verification, bank payouts, fee questions, and reconciliation.

AGAPAY Support

How to Reach Us	Details
Website	agapay.app
Issue Types	Stripe Express access, payouts, verification, fees, transaction questions, and platform support
Response Time	Typically within one business day
Helpful Information	Transaction ID, payout ID, date, amount, parish name, and screenshots of any Stripe alert

Contacting Stripe Directly

Some issues can be handled inside Stripe Express using its Help or Support links. However, because AGAPAY operates the platform relationship, AGAPAY should usually be contacted first.

TIP

When asking about a specific donation or payout, include the date, amount, transaction ID or payout ID, and a screenshot of any dashboard alert. This helps AGAPAY resolve the issue faster.



AGAPAY

Thank you for being part of AGAPAY. Your parish's faithful stewardship of online giving helps build the financial home of the Orthodox world - one family at a time.

Love how you give.